What South Sumatra's Data Reveals

Problems and relationships found in the dashboard, 2015-2025

17 regencies and cities · Source: BPS Provinsi Sumatera Selatan

Summary: the province improved

10.15%

poverty rate, down from 14.25% in 2015

3.69%

open unemployment, from 5.59% in 2015

74.8

HDI, up from 67.5 in 2015

735

GRDP in IDR tn (current prices), from 337

Province-level view from the dashboard's summary cards. The averages hide large gaps between areas.

Problem 1: progress is uneven

Poverty gap

Muratara has the highest poverty in 2025 (15.25%), Pagar Alam the lowest (7.70%).

Concentrated economy

Palembang alone produces 31% of provincial GRDP; the top 3 areas produce 62%.

Urban unemployment

Palembang has 6.81% unemployment vs 3.69% for the province. 3 of the top 5 areas are cities.

Problem 2: top output, middle-ranked HDI

Muara Enim

Muara Enim: GRDP rank 2, HDI rank 7, poverty rank 11 of 17 (1 = highest).

Musi Banyuasin

Musi Banyuasin: GRDP rank 3, HDI rank 10, poverty rank 9 of 17 (1 = highest).

Pandemic shock

In 2020, 7 of 17 areas had negative per-capita growth. Recovery differed by area.

Which indicators move together?

Relationship	Expected	Data (r)	Verdict
HDI → Poverty	▼ negative	-0.43	Supported
GRDP → HDI	▲ positive	+0.37	Supported
Growth → Poverty	▼ negative	-0.08	No clear link
Unemployment → Poverty	▲ positive	+0.14	No clear link
Gini → Poverty	▲ positive	-0.16	No clear link
HDI → Unemployment	▼ negative	+0.47	Opposite to theory

r = correlation across all 17 areas and 11 years. Correlation shows a pattern, not a cause.

What we can learn

Human development matters

Better HDI goes with lower poverty: skills, health and income raise household earnings.

Size is not welfare

Growth and poverty show no clear link, and the top-GRDP areas rank only 7th and 10th in HDI.

Cities: chances and queues

Higher HDI goes with higher unemployment, perhaps because educated urban job-seekers wait for formal jobs (a hypothesis).

Implications to explore

- Target poverty programs at the highest-poverty areas, starting with Muratara.
- Education and health show the clearest link with lower poverty (to be tested).
- Look beyond output: track poverty and HDI next to GRDP.
- Study urban job matching, since city unemployment is the highest.
- Next data to add: population, GRDP by industry, inflation.